

In our benchmarks, the iQOO Neo 10 scored over 1.7 million on AnTuTu. It comfortably places itself in flagship territory and ahead of most phones in its segment as well. Even on Geekbench, the scores were pretty solid. But here's the interesting part: the iQOO Neo 10R, its cheaper sibling (Rs 26,999), is not far behind. On AnTuTu, it's only about two lakh points lower, and Geekbench scores were also within a tight margin.

We also ran a stress test: 15 minutes under normal load and 30 minutes under heavy load, and here's where things got a bit unpredictable. While the phone started strong, we noticed a zig-zag performance pattern after a point. Sudden dips, quick recoveries, and then dips again. It wasn't gradual throttling; it was erratic, and that's something gamers will definitely feel, especially in competitive scenarios.

We have already flagged this and notified the iQOO team, and they've assured us that a future OTA update will address it. Fingers crossed!

That said, the overall gaming experience on the Neo 10 is smooth. In our tests, it ran BGMI at over 98% stability. We recorded an average of 102 FPS and a peak of 121 FPS. So yes, gaming is a treat. No major thermal throttling either.

CAMERA

The iQOO Neo 10 packs a dual camera set-up with a 50-megapixel main camera and an 8-megapixel ultra-wide lens. On the front, it has a massive 32-megapixel selfie shooter.

From the main camera, in daylight, the iQOO Neo 10 produces bright, vivid, and colourful shots. They are a bit saturated, not too much on the natural side. It tries to retain the details as much as possible in most places but misses out on the sharpness in some cases. There's a yellow hue to the pictures as well. Overall, the pictures are pleasant to look at.

Low-light shots look bright, the phone tries to manage the light well, too, and there aren't too many light bleeds. However, details are missed as there is some softening in the shots.



Portraits turn out nice, the subject-object separation and the bokeh look nice. The edge detection is decent, but it does miss the spot in some cases. The skin tones look natural mostly, but there's some smoothening on the face.

BATTERY

So, with the iQOO Neo 10, you get a huge 7000mAh battery, and yes, it supports 120-watt fast charging, and yes, this battery lasts. In our PCMark battery life test, the iQOO Neo 10 clocked in over 22 hours. But again, one interesting bit: In the same test, the iQOO Neo 10R actually lasted a few minutes longer than the iQOO Neo 10.

Now, sure, it's just a few minutes, but what makes it worth noting is that on paper, the Neo 10R comes with a smaller battery size than the Neo 10.

Still, when you compare the iQOO Neo 10 with other smartphones at this price point, it clearly pulls ahead. And once you throw how fast it charges into the equation, the iQOO Neo 10 outperforms its R sibling by a decent margin. It takes just around 40 minutes to go from 0 to 100%, while the iQOO Neo 10R takes about 67 minutes.

BOTTOMLINE

Now, you might be thinking, at ₹31,999, the iQOO Neo 10 sounds like a great deal. And honestly, it is. But then, there's the iQOO Neo 10R. It offers similar camera performance, scores only slightly below the Neo 10 in performance tests,



has the same design language, and even edges ahead in battery life. Most importantly, it's Rs 5,000 cheaper. And for many people, the Neo 10R might be a tempting option for that reason.

But before you make a decision, here's what that extra Rs 5,000 gets you with the iQOO Neo 10: a more premium in-hand feel (even if it looks the same), a brighter and colour-accurate display, slightly sharper camera output, faster charging, and a newer chipset that delivers top-tier performance.

So if you're someone who values these small-but-meaningful upgrades, the iQOO Neo 10 stands out as a performance-first all-rounder, and one of the strongest options you can get for ₹31,999 right now.

—Mustafa Khan

SPECIFICATIONS

Screen: 6.78-inch 1.5K AMOLED | SoC: Snapdragon 8s Gen 4 | RAM: 8GB | Storage: 128GB | Camera: 50MP + 8MP (Rear), 50MP (Front) | Battery: 7000 mAh, 120W fast charge | Weight: 206g | Other: Type-C port, Wi-Fi 7 support

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